

i-HUB GUJARAT

Powering Innovation Through a Statewide Hub and Spoke Network

Catalysing a Statewide Innovation and Entrepreneurship Movement

As India advances towards its vision of becoming a developed nation by 2047, innovation and entrepreneurship are emerging as powerful engines of economic growth, technological advancement, and job creation. Over the past decade, initiatives such as Startup India, the Startup India Seed Fund Scheme, the Atal Innovation Mission, Digital India, and Make in India have helped India emerge as the world's third largest startup ecosystem with more than 2.2 lakh DPIIT recognised startups.

Within this national transformation, Gujarat has established itself as one of the most dynamic innovation driven states in India. Today, the state hosts more than 19,000 DPIIT recognised startups operating across sectors such as DeepTech, Agritech, FinTech, Healthcare, Manufacturing, Sustainability, Education, and Defence Technology. Supported by more than 200 incubation centres, startup activity has expanded beyond Ahmedabad, Surat, Rajkot, and Vadodara into Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities.

Gujarat has built a collaborative platform linking academia, industry, investors, government, and startups. At the heart of this transformation stands i-Hub Gujarat, established under SSIP 2.0 of the Education Department, Government of Gujarat.

Conceived as a bridge between innovation and commercialisation, i-Hub Gujarat has evolved into a comprehensive ecosystem enabler that helps innovators transform ideas into sustainable enterprises.

The Institutional Backbone of Gujarat's Startup Ecosystem

i-Hub Gujarat serves as an integrated platform supporting innovation and entrepreneurship across the state.

The institution functions simultaneously as:

- **Project Management Unit for SSIP 2.0**
- **State level startup incubator**
- **Funding and investment facilitator**
- **Intellectual property support centre**
- **Innovation ecosystem enabler**
- **Bridge connecting startups with industry, investors, government, and global markets**

With more than 750 startups supported and substantial investments mobilised, i-Hub has emerged as a catalyst for innovation driven growth.

Addressing Critical Gaps in the Startup Journey

Every successful enterprise begins with an idea. However, many innovators struggle to move beyond the concept stage because they lack entrepreneurial exposure, mentorship, market understanding, and early stage financial support.

To address this challenge, i-Hub Gujarat implements the Startup Srujan Seed Support Scheme (S4), which provides grants ranging from ₹2.5 lakh to ₹10 lakh for idea validation, proof of concept development, prototype creation, and market assessment. Innovators also receive mentoring and capacity building support.

More than ₹28 crore has been sanctioned to over 450 startups and innovators, enabling aspiring entrepreneurs to transform ideas into viable business opportunities.

Strengthening Product Validation and Market Readiness

A prototype that performs successfully in a laboratory often faces entirely different challenges when exposed to real world conditions. Startups frequently encounter costs related to testing, certification, quality assurance, and regulatory approvals.

The Testing and Validation Support Programme addresses this gap by providing assistance of up to ₹10 lakh per startup for certifications and compliance with internationally recognised standards such as CE, USFDA, SGS, and TUV. The programme helps improve product credibility and market readiness.

Facilitating Pilot Deployments and Market Demonstration

Even a validated product requires proof of performance in real operating environments before customers and investors are willing to commit. Through the Product and Service Piloting Programme, startups receive support of up to ₹10 lakh for pilot deployments and field validation. The programme facilitates collaboration with government departments, municipal corporations, and public institutions, enabling startups to validate solutions in real world environments.

Advancing Intellectual Property Protection

In today's knowledge driven economy, intellectual property has become one of the most valuable assets for innovation led enterprises. Yet many startups struggle with the complexities and costs

